West on 57th Street - - - By CARLE HODGE

At a New York sculpture exhibit, a society lady was charmed not long ago by a whatsit which looked like a malformed man from Mars with a hole in his head. She beamed fondly. She also purred over a towering metal glob that appeared to be nothing in particular. But then she stopped agape before a small statuette, a lifelike likeness of a rider perched for the moment atop a rank bronc. "My God," she cried, "what's that?"

Such exclamations long ago ceased surprising Frederic Allen Williams, who moulded the figure of the rampant horse. A gray, thickset man of 55, he has devoted more years to rodeo than any other sculptor. He is quite used to the fact that other slicked-up cowman. He is a rare and good sight as he clomps, high-hatted and big-booted, down Manhattan streets. When the niceties of his trade force him to wear a tuxedo, a situation he despises, he slips on black dress boots. Actually, his bent for cowboying simply grew out of his love for horses. There have been horses in his family almost as long as there have been Williamses (one grandfather was a Civil War cavalry officer), though nothing in Allen's Yankee childhood hinted that he would grow up preferring chaps to champagne. His family was prosperously proper Bostonian, and he was taught Latin and Greek and sent off to art schools in New York and Europe.



Photo by the author.

Williams doing bust of William R. Leigh, famous Western artist.

New Yorkers look with a wry eye upon him and his efforts. Williams lives and labors on West 57th Street, the city's artiest avenue. But his barn-sized studio resembles a cluttered museum. It is a hodge-podge of spurs, saddles, Indian jewelry and Navajo rugs. Jampacked to the high ceiling is his work on rodeo in clay and bronze. Among it are plaques depicting each event, broncs by the corral-full, a model of producer Everett Colborn's Longhorn "Old Red" and a realistic pose of a hulking Brahma bull.

His fondness for the latter critters may startle bull riders. "The hump-backed beasts," he says, "will drive crazy any artist who works with animals. It's hard to explain, but a Brahma is an especially beautiful animal. It's something about his design, the proportions, the muscle play. His ears have a soft quality and the eyes have tremendous expression." Williams finished his model by working inside the pen with the bull only a lunge away. He found the Brahma, without a loose-rope at least, to be a gentleman. In fact, the only animal Williams has found an ornery poser was a pet fawn, when he was living at Taos, New Mexico. The deer kept nibbling bites off the working model.

There is so much of the sprawl of the wide West in Allen William's high-heeled gait, and the look of off-path places in his face, that often the bachelor artist is mistaken even in the Beef Belt for a

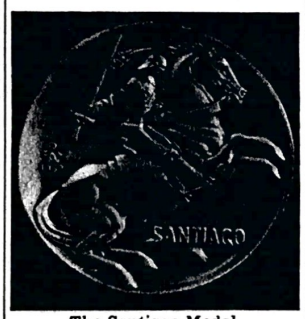
This spell was broken by a brief World War I hitch. The Army, unimpressed by the fact that his Colonial forebears had helped chase out the English, never took him off Manhattan Island. (A messmate was Joe Koller, the Belle Fourche rodeo secretary, but the two didn't meet until thirty years later when the sculptor went to the Black Hills Round-Up to take pictures.) About this war time, two events changed the young artist's life. He saw his first rodeo, and he met Dan Frost, a trader then importing Czech beads for barter with Indian handicraftsmen. He was never far thereafter from either cowboys or Indians. Frost introduced him by mail to John Hamley, the Pendleton saddlemaker, who promised Allen a job on an Oregon cow spread.

Williams was as tickled as a kid who's finally won day-money. When he ended art school in 1925, he headed for a summer's ranch-handing—and his first seat in a saddle. He'd ridden bareback since he was hock-high to a colt, but his father, a doctor, always argued that saddles were dangerous. That Oregon year also took Allen to his first Pendleton Round-Up. He's been back four times, three of them judging the Indian beauty contest.

Not surprisingly, his first paying chore as a sculptor was to do an Indian figure, and the next summer, 1926, he went to New Mexico and Arizona to model Navajos. While there he learned that four of his sculptures had been picked for showing by the National Academy of Design, an awesome record for the lofty Academy. Since then, he has commuted between the West, which he loves, and the East, where he says he must live in order to pursue his calling and still be able to jingle jack in his jeans. In the West, he has sat beside Indian ceremonial fires, helped run a trading post, shot thousands of photographs (jumping his share of arena fences to escape the Brahmas), pack-trailed hundreds of mountain miles and explored ruins. He has lectured widely on the West and painted it on canvas.

Back East, all the while, he has been sitting high in sculpturing. Leading galleries, among them Phillip's Wooloroc Museum at Bartlesville, Oklahoma, exhibit his work. His many busts include radio-tube inventor Lee De Forest (Yale owns that one), Will Rogers, Charley Russell, Lindbergh, outdoorsman Dan Beard and Adm. Richard E. Byrd. He recently completed another of William R. Leigh, probably the greatest living painter of the old West. Last year Williams' plaque of a Conestoga wagon won a prize as the "work most meritorious" of its kind. Copies of his medallion showing Santiago, the patron saint of horsemen, are popular as tie clips and earrings, as well as religious charms. Newscaster Edward R. Murrow sports a pair of cufflinks made from them.

It is, unhappily, his citified work which buys the beans, but that on horses and rodeo which Frederic Allen Williams likes best to do. He still reads HOOFS AND HORNS more avidly than The Art News. He would like to help set up a Museum of the Horse—before the last of the steeds disappear into dogfood grinders. Most of all, he hopes to design some rodeo trophies. "The boys," he says, "should have something, for when they quit, to remember rodeo by. And it's pretty silly giving them loving cups and silver plates made for bridge tournaments and quilting bees. The trouble is, rodeo committees are used to ordering cheap, assembly-line prizes out of catalogs. They aren't willing to pay for something which really looks like rodeo."



The Santiago Medal.

Rodeoers are among Williams' closest friends, all around the circuit. At Madison Square Garden's noisy indoor bedlam each fall, he is an oldtimer at behind-the-chutes shop talk, and he usually rides with visiting hands in the traditional parade down Broadway. Often his studio turns into a bunkhouse for them. He still laughs about the night he had to whisk his Longhorn statue from a sleeping dogger's iron arm-lock; the dogger was having a nightmare. One thing, though, is sure: The he-manly smell of sweat and liniment hasn't hurt fashionable 57th Street a-tall.

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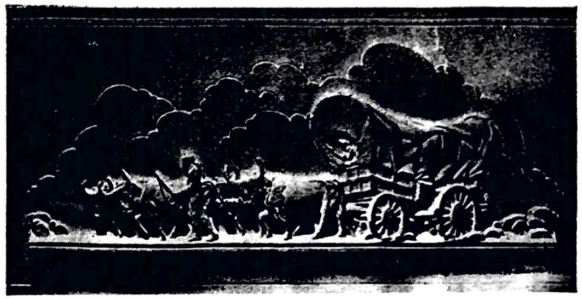
MR. WILLIAMS WORKING ON HIS PORTRAIT-HEAD OF THE PAINTER, W. R. LEIGH

EXHIBITED BY THE NATIONAL ACADEMY OF DESIGN 1955

Lectures by Frederic Allen Williams
On SCULPTURE

(1956 — 1957)

1. **THE SCULPTURES OF NEW YORK** (1956-Centennial Observanse) Some of the hundreds of monumental works in the City
2. **THE NEW YORK WORLD'S FAIR OF 1939-40** As seen by day and night, International Art and natives
3. **THE BROOKGREEN GARDENS,** South Carolina A parade of American Sculpture in a Southern Outdoor setting.
4. **THE FABULOUS SIDEWALKS OF NEW YORK,** mostly at night The incomparable color on street and the shop windows at Holiday time.
5. **POLYCHROME SCULPTURE** thru the ages, depicts the great variety of media and means used by the master sculptors.
6. **THE HORSE** (contains much sculpture) as subject and motif in various materials since the dawn of civilization.



COVERED WAGON #2. LINDSEY-MORRIS PRIZE. ALLIED ARTISTS 1952

On TRAVEL

7. **MEXICO,** Yucatan, from Oaxaca to Lake Chapala, scenes, ruins and art.
8. **TAOS TO TUCSON,** Mountains, Deserts, Indians and Art.
9. **THE BLACK HILLS** includes Deadwood and Belle Fourche Roundup.
10. **OREGON** The Columbia, Ranches and the Pendleton Roundup.
11. **SCENES OF NEW ENGLAND** includes Boston, Cape Cod, Maine Seacoast and Vermont Mountains.
12. **INTERESTING HISTORY AND COLOR ON LONG ISLAND.**
13. **CANADA, CALGARY STAMPEDE** and The Rocky Mountain Trail Club Ride.
14. **CANADA,** Quebec, Isle d'Orleans, The Gaspe and native arts.

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15. Arts of the North and South American Indian
16. Arts of the North American Indians.
17. Arts of the South American Indians.
18. Arts of Mexico.

Each of the Above Include Pre-Columbian, Colonial and Modern Art

NATURE

19. **FLOWERS,** pictured as an artist sees them.

These talks are illustrated with extraordinarily fine original natural-color photos taken by the artist. With the pictures he gives a running comment of interest to artist and layman.

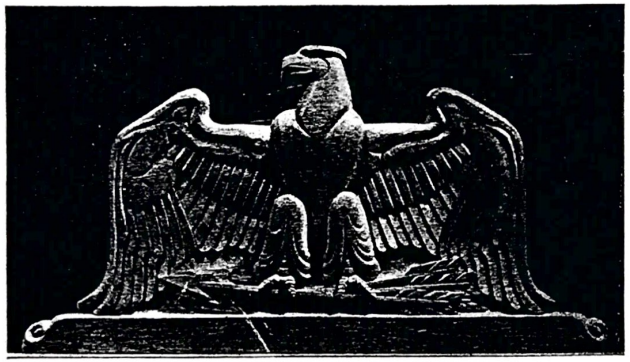
Literally it has taken years to assemble these talks, to which the artist is ever adding or replacing. It can be said that no lecture has ever been repeated verbatum. The slides are all 3¼" x 4" because the artist believes that the beauty of composition and the richness of color cannot be obtained on smaller film. Since the speaker is also a trained artist, the comment is often made that his photos are like paintings.

In the past 23 years the artist has entertained all types of clubs, schools, historic and patriotic societies, civic organizations, art groups and in Veterans Hospitals for the Red Cross. The best recommendation is that the usual and voluble request is for more.

The speaker, Frederic Allen Williams, was born in Boston, but brought up in New England, New York, Florida, Minnesota, Oregon and the Southwest. He is as much at home at a cattle ranch in Oregon or an Indian Reservation as he is in New York. Briefly, he is a member of the National Sculpture Society, The Allied Artists, American Veterans Society of Artists, Historical Societies, The Rodeo Cowboys Assn., and The Westerners.

Among his many other activities may be mentioned his numberless appearances on Sheriff Bob Dixon (CBS T. V.) program. For Gary Moore's T. V. Show, he modeled a life-size cow in butter and during the Capt. Kangaroo, T. V. show he modeled a portrait of the star. The photograph on the front of this folder was taken by a photographer of the N. Y. Herald-Tribune and shows Mr. Williams riding with the Rodeo Cowboys from Madison Square Garden entertaining at Bellevue Hospital.

Also Mr. Williams has made a very comprehensive collection of the various types of Indian Art from North and South America. But his greatest hobby is his Horse and Cowboy Museum.



CARVED WOOD EAGLE, PART OF THE EMPLOYEES WAR MEMORIAL OF THE CROSLEY RADIO CORP. CINCINNATI



MR. WILLIAMS ON COL. THOMPSON'S FAMOUS PARADE HORSE
N. Y. HERALD TRIBUNE PHOTO

FREDERIC ALLEN WILLIAMS
ILLUSTRATED LECTURES

58 West 57th Street

T Red. Williams Coll. 73.138.107

Reproduction of the mural portrait of George Washington by Wilford S. Conrow, painted for the George Washington Life Insurance Company, Charleston, West Virginia. The painting has been on public exhibition in the National Gallery of Art, Washington, D. C., and in the Ehrich Galleries, Fifth Avenue, New York.

NEW YORK TIMES, May 15, 1921 -- "No other portrait of Washington gives just this sense of fitness to meet the most critical of problems and to dominate the fate of a nation."

Elizabeth Luther Cary, Art Critic.

BOSTON EVENING TRANSCRIPT, May 20, 1921 -- "It is the only portrait in our country which satisfies both the historian, the artist and the student of human nature."

Dr. Gustavus A. Eisen, Research Archaeologist.

TIMOTHY COLE, N. A. -- "This Washington is really a great picture, a marvelously fine thing -- a really monumental accomplishment."

MR. W. LANIER WASHINGTON, the closest relative in this generation of General Washington and a well known collector and student of Washingtoniana: -- "This reproduction of the portrait of George Washington by Wilford S. Conrow is an approximation of the original. I have examined critically practically every known portrait of Washington, and in my opinion, Mr. Conrow's conception of the Father of His Country embodies truthful likeness, virility and artistic quality in the highest degree, which entitles his painting to be classed with the most notable portraits of Washington that were painted from life, and superior to any of them in characterization. I never before have seen a portrait of Washington that so fully satisfied my conceptions of his actual appearance, physical, intellectual and spiritual."

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NEW YORK

CABLE ADDRESS
LOIS EHRICH

June 4th, 1931

Mr. Wilfred S. Conrow
Carnegie Studios
cor. 57th St. & 7th Avenue
New York City

Dear Mr. Conrow:

Referring to your painting of George Washington based on the thought "where there is no vision the people perish", I well remember the great interest there was in this picture when we exhibited it in our window on Fifth Avenue. We had intended to leave it in only for Washington's birthday, but it attracted so much attention that we left it in about a week, if I remember correctly. To my mind it is certainly the most interesting painting painted of Washington since his death. It is the type of picture which should be in the National Portrait Gallery in Washington.

With kind regards,

Sincerely yours,

Nat. Ehrich

WLR:SG

58 WEST 57TH STREET, N. Y. C. 19 CO 5-5645

FREDERIC ALLEN WILLIAMS

Art Studio

SCULPTOR · PAINTER · PHOTOGRAPHER · LECTURER

FREDERIC ALLEN WILLIAMS

Art Studio

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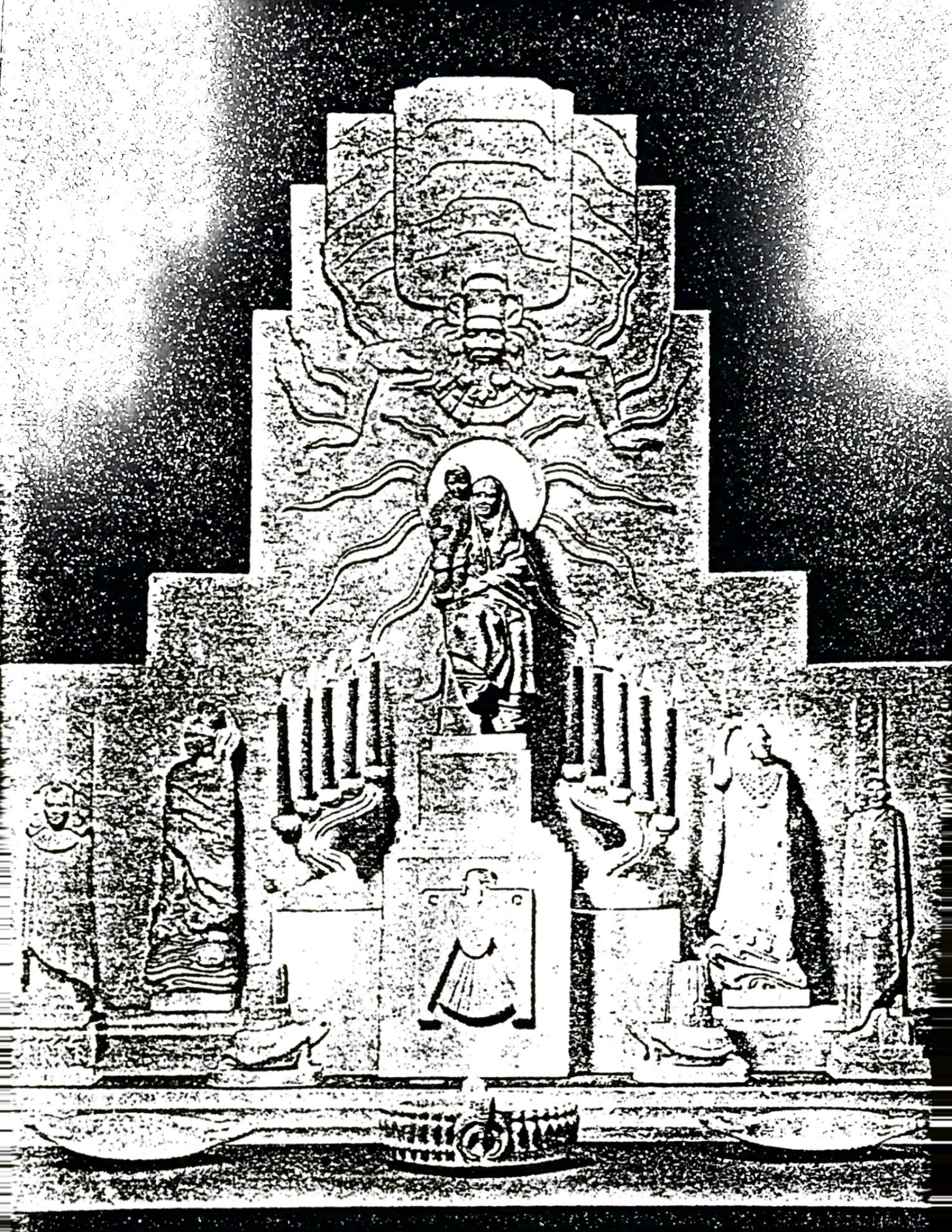
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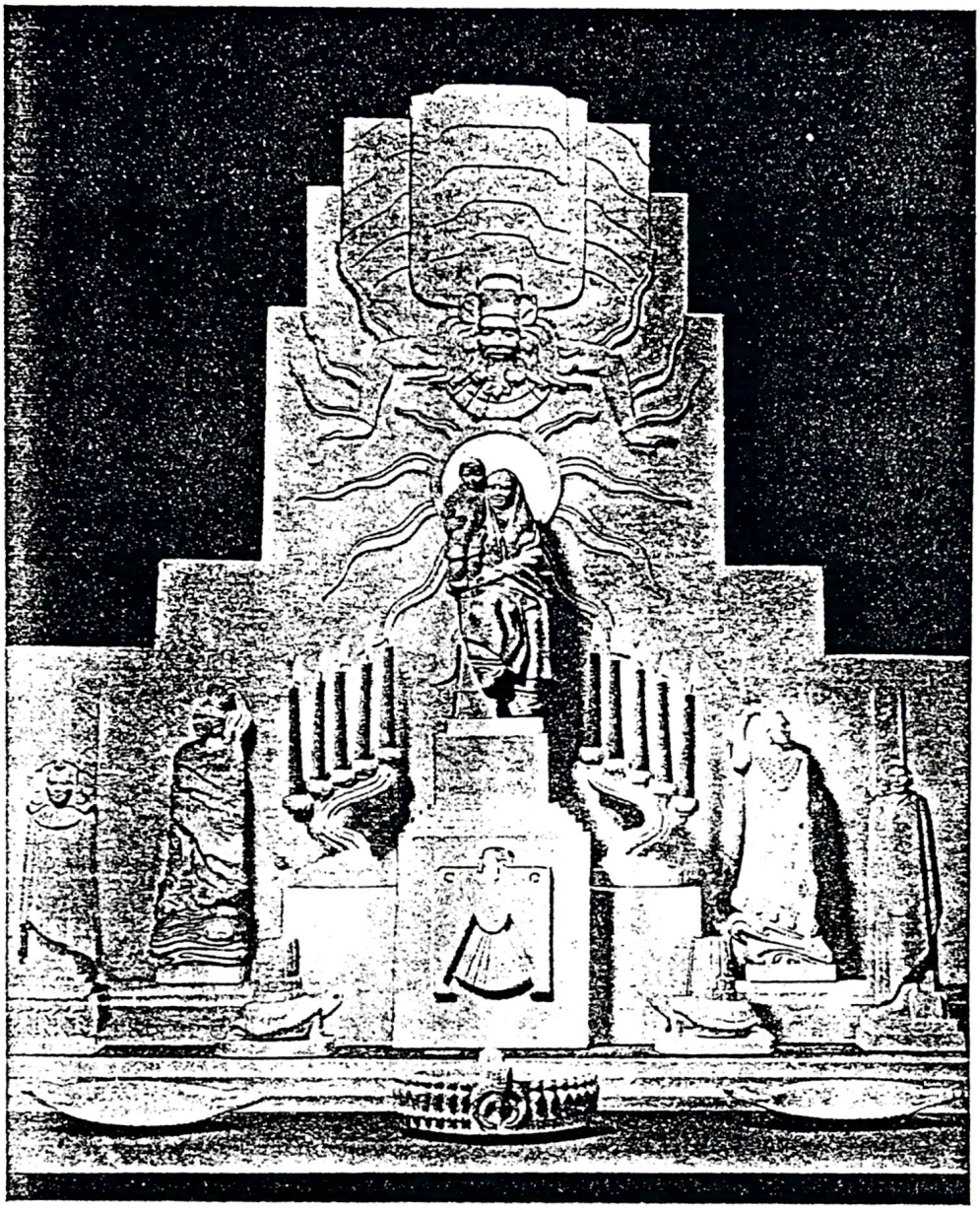
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WILLIAMS, Frederic Allen, sculptor; b. West Newton, Mass., April 10, 1898; s. Dr. Frederic Allen and Elizabeth Allen (Paine) W.; student Boston Latin School, 1913-17, Columbia Univ., 1918-20, Beaux Art Inst. of Design, 1921-23 Nat. Acad. of Design, 1921-29. Sculptures include: The Arrowmaker (Sundial), Arkel Museum Canjoharie, N.Y.; portrait busts of Edwin Markham, Percey MacKaye, Edgar Allen Poe, Historic Arts Galleries, N.Y.; busts of Dan C. Beard, Will Rogers, Charlie Russell, Clyde Pangborn, Augustus Post, Alan Hawley, Ilya Tolstoi, Admiral R. Byrd, Poultney Bigelow (relief) Silago Nez (navaho); portrait head of Edgar Stillman Kelley, Gallery of the American Acad. of Arts and Letters, Charles Peter Berkey, Columbia Univ.; memorial tablet to Mrs Thea Heye, Heye Foundation of the Am. Indian; plaque portraits of Hugo Eckner, Count Zeppelin, Town Hall, Friedrichshafen, Ger. Exhibitions: The Nat Acad. of Design, N.Y., The Architectural League of N.Y. The Am. Federation of Arts, The Nat. Sculpture Soc. The San Francisco Sculpture Exposition, The Brooklyn Museum, Santa Fe Museum, Am. Vets. Soc. of Artists, Inc., and others. Listed lecturer on Mexico, Indian Arts of the U. S., Arts of Mexico, Indian Arts of the Americans, The Arts of Peru, Pottery, Polychrome Sculpture, The Sculptures of New York demonstration lecture of a sculptor working; for the Coordinator of Inter-American Affairs, Pan-American Union; works reproduced in porcelain include llama, Rocky Mountain sheep, horse heads, fawn, frog, pelican, also done in porcelain, Madonna of the Americans; current work includes Shrine of the Americas, Pecos Bill and a monument to aeronaut Leo Stevens. Received special award for the Madonna of the Americas in porcelain, Professional Artists League Show, N.Y.C., 1945. Mem. Am. Vets. Soc. of Artists, Inc. (pres.), Am. Rough Riders, Inc. (v.p.), N.Y. Ceramic Soc., Am. Artists Professional League, Artist Guild, Sons of the Am. Revolution, Rodeo Cowboys Assn., Ends of the Earth, Trail Riders of the Canadian Rockies, Minn. Historical Soc., Fla. Soc. in the East. Episcopalian. Author of articles: Americas' Greatest Invention (Horse), Deep in the Heart of Texas, Pendleton Roundup, Calgary Stampede and others. Home: 58 West 57th St., New York 19, N.Y.

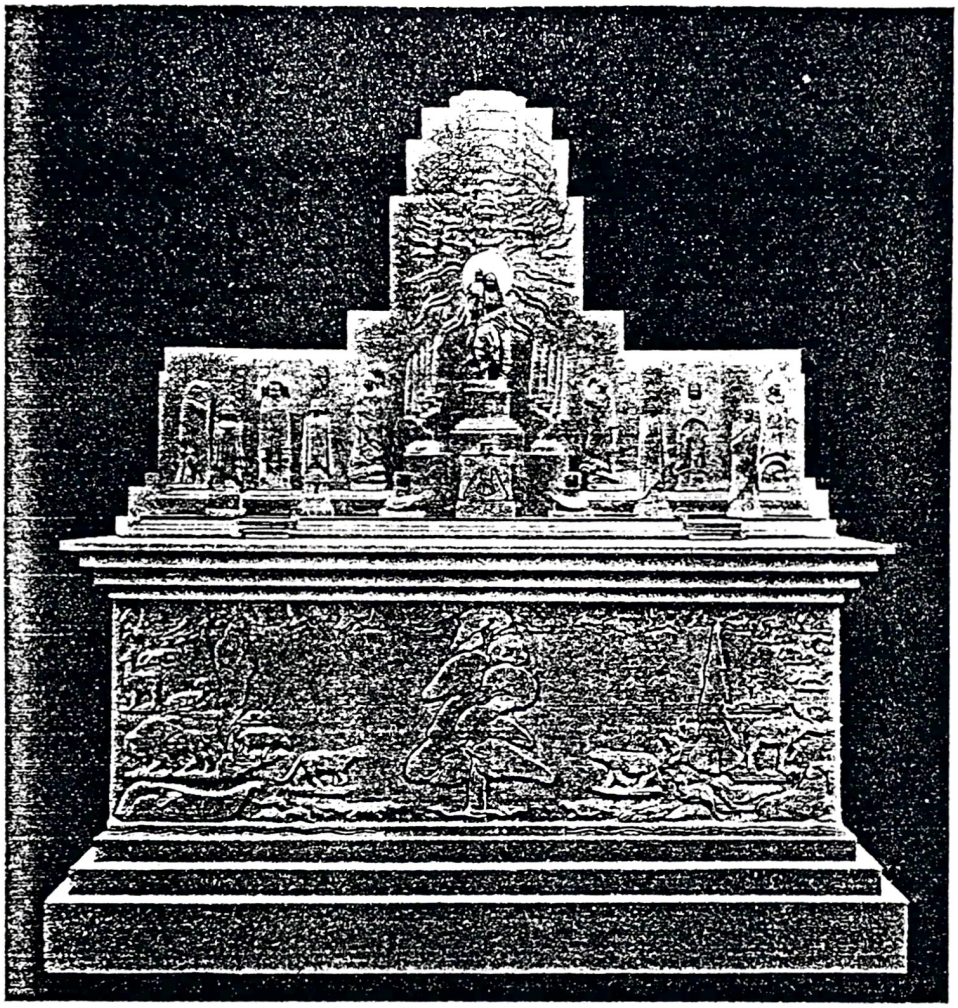
Reprint from
"INTERNATIONAL WHO'S WHO"
January 1948





AN INTER-AMERICAN MONUMENT

DEDICATED TO THE PEOPLES, CULTURES AND CIVILIZATIONS,
PAST AND PRESENT, OF THE WESTERN HEMISPHERE



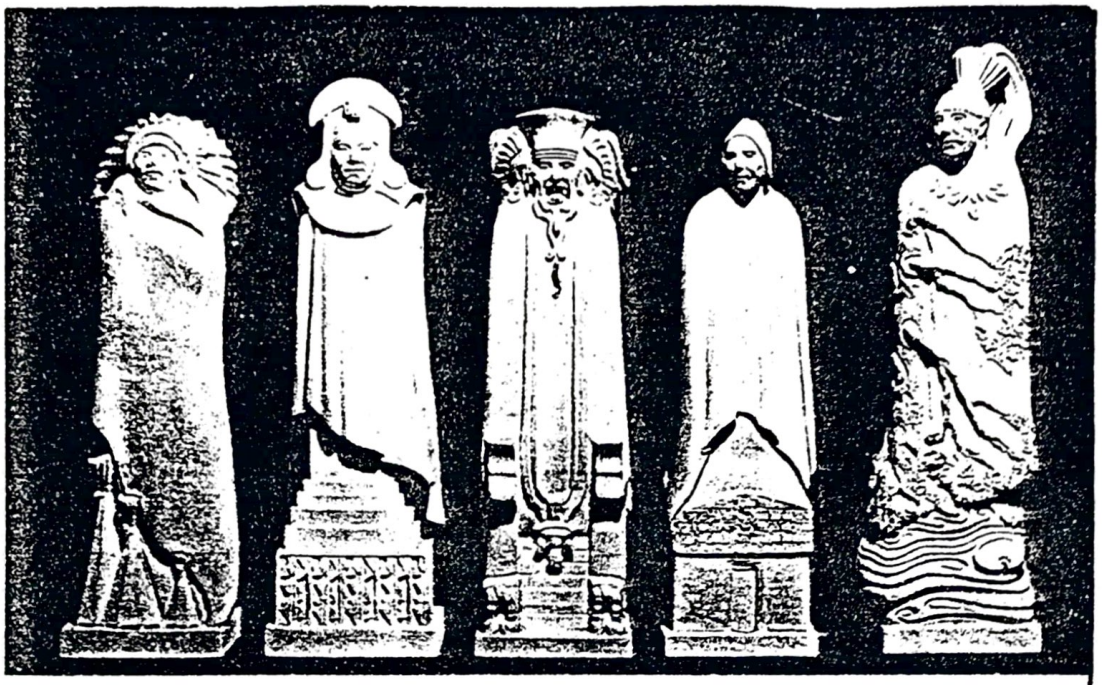
"SHRINE OF THE AMERICAS". COPYRIGHT 1939, FREDERIC ALLEN WILLIAMS

This project and the model (eight feet high), illustrated herein, is the work of Frederic Allen Williams, American Sculptor, who has spent most of the past twelve years on the research and labor that this work has required.

Mr. Williams earnestly invites and welcomes any and all suggestions toward the completion of this INTER-AMERICAN MONUMENT.

The model may be viewed by appointment. Phone or write

FREDERIC ALLEN WILLIAMS
58 West 57th Street, New York, 19 COlumbus 5-5645



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THE WEST COAST
SOUTH AMERICA

THE MAYA
CENTRAL AMERICA

THE HIGHLANDS
SOUTH AMERICA

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The people of America should preserve with pride the arts and the cultures of those civilizations which have developed in this land where our ancestors found a haven and freedom.

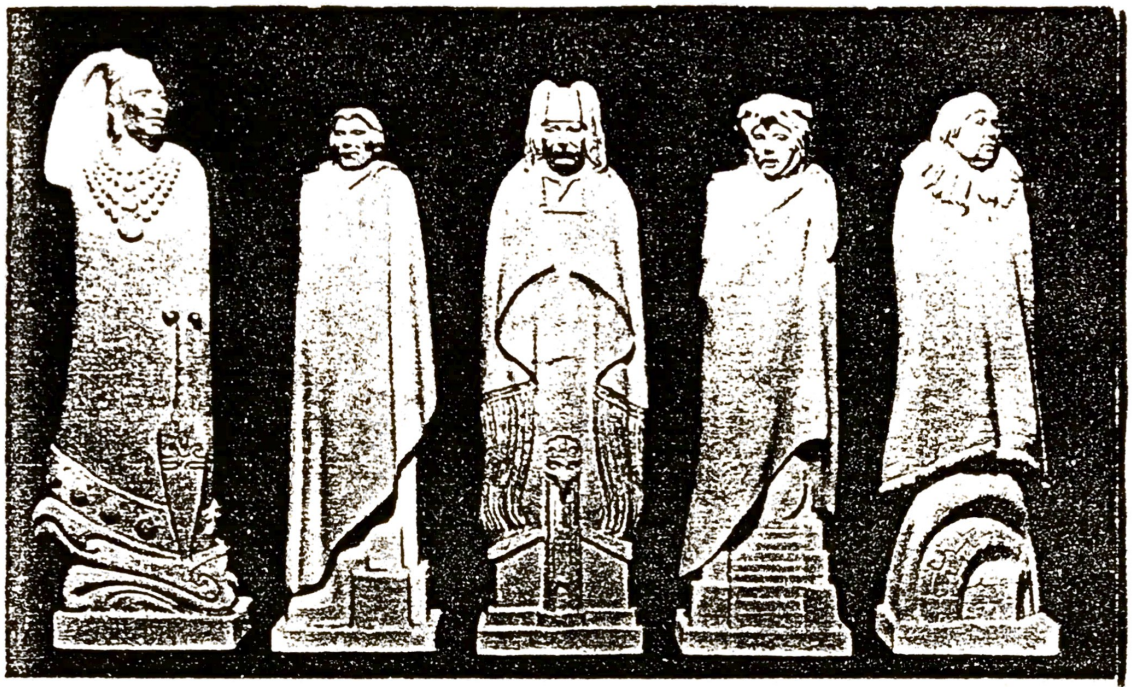
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Prof. L. C. Orozco, Mexican Commissioner of Indian Affairs, 1940.

Mr. L. S. Rowe, Director-General of the Pan-American Union.

George Heye, Chairman and Director of the Museum of The American Indian.

James T. Shotwell of the Carnegie Endowment for International Peace.

Donald Robb, late consultant for the National Cathedral, Washington, D. C.

Roberta Campbell Lawson, late National President of the Federation of Women's Clubs.

Mrs. Edgar Stillman Kelley, Past President of the National Federation of Music Clubs.

Mrs. William H. Pouch, President-General of The Daughters of the American Revolution.

Mrs. Ruth Harkness, author and explorer.

Madame Maria Currea de Aya, of Colombia, South America, member of the Inter-American Commission of Women.

FREDERIC WILLIAMS COLLECTION

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This cardboard cover with ties has been de-accessioned.

The measurements were the same as the prints, 16 3/4 x 19 1/2".

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khg/87